

THE SINGH SABHA MOVEMENT

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The first attempt at reform, in the shape of the Namdhari movement, was successfully paralysed owing to the want of a common feeling among the Sikhs, which could be engendered only by education. It is a significant fact that while all other communities at that time got the inspiration for reform from Western education, the Sikhs' first endeavours in this line were the results of their own inherent genius. They realized, however, that their attempts to rouse the whole community to feel the necessity of reform would be fruitless unless they first got themselves educated. The Government also learnt a lesson that, in their own interest, they should not antagonise the reforming element among the Sikhs; rather they should help it and, if possible, to guide it in the work of reform. Political contingency may have required that as many elements as possible should be segregated from the general body of Hindus who were responsible for the agitation for political reform in India. But it would be unjust to accuse Sir Sayyad Ahmad or his counterparts among Sikhs of misguiding their communities to serve the ends of the British Government in India. It was in the interest of Sikhs and Mohammedans that before they could consciously and usefully take part in the political life of India they should go through a discipline of education and religious reform. Both these communities were backward in this respect, and they were quite justified in cooperating with the Government in order to secure the much-needed help from them.

So far as the Sikhs were concerned, it was inevitable that the movement of reform among them should take the form of dehinduising them. This would have come, even if the Government had stood aside, because the only trouble with Sikhism at that time was that its doctrines and institutions had been completely Hinduised. The reformers, therefore, had a tremendous task before them to rediscover the pure doctrine and then to preach it to the ignorant masses.

Khalsa Diwan Of Amritsar

The first association of reform, called the Singh Sabha, was founded at Amritsar in 1873, only a year after the Namdhari trouble. Its inaugural meeting was held at the Manji Sahib at 2 o'clock on the Dussehra day. It was attended by the Pujaris, Mahants, Gyanis, Granthis, Udasis, Nirmalas, beside prominent Sardars like, S. Thakur Singh Sandhawlia, who was moving spirit of the body. Its weekly meetings were held at the Manji Sahib (where even now you may find a dilapidated room bearing a sign-board of the Sabha). In the meetings lectures and discussion were held in an atmosphere of controversy and denunciation which did not allow much of the spiritual content. It was perhaps necessary at that time. Gyani Sardul Singh put forward appointment for discussion that the birthday of Guru Nanak should be celebrated in the month of Vaisakh instead of Kartik. The discussion went on for three years, and as a result a *Gurparnali* or calendar was prepared giving the true dates of the births and deaths of the Gurus. An other subject for discussion was the text of the *Dasam Granth* which was subjected to a close examination for the purpose of discovering how much of it was Guru Gobind Singh's own composition, and how much came from other writers. Thirty-two different versions were collected to work upon. The work growing apace, it was entrusted to a separate body, constituted under the Singh Sabha, which was called the Gurmat Granth Pracharak Sabha. Dr. Charan Singh (Father of Bhai Vir Singh) was its secretary. The work of collating the different texts was completed in 1896, and its report was published in 1897, embodying the results of the research and preparing a true recension of the Dasam Granth. Inspired by these researches other work of great importance were prepared, such as Gyani Gyan Singh's *Panth Prakash* and *Gur Twarikh Gur Khalsa*, Pandit Tara Singh's *Gur Granth Kosh* and *Tirath Sangrah*, etc. In 1894 Bhai Kaur Singh and Bhai Vir Singh established the Khalsa Tract Society, Amritsar, for the purpose of issuing monthly tracts on Sikh religion. This society has done much to popularize Punjabi and the stories of Sikh history.

Beside the Singh Sabha of Amritsar, there were other centers where similar associations were being formed. The most important of such places was Lahore, where professor Gurmukh Singh was working most zealously with the purpose of organizing Sikhs and making them feel their lost individuality. Through his influence in 1877 classes were opened in the Oriental College for teaching Punjabi as the only¹ modern Indian Language besides the classical languages. He himself was appointed Lecturer in Punjabi, besides Bhai Harsa Singh and later on Bhai Dit Singh, as an additional teacher. Prof. Gurmukh Singh was the greatest figure in the Singh Sabha movement. Besides being a great scholar of Sikhism, he possessed a strong personality which overawed

even Rajas and Maharajas. He had a clear vision of Sikhism as conceived by the Gurus, and was determined to restore it to its original shape without any compromise with Hinduism. He had the knack of gathering about him men of sterling worth. With their help he founded a Singh Sabha at Lahore, on 2nd of November, 1879, and got it affiliated to the Singh Sabha of Amritsar which became the central body called the Khalsa Diwan, Amritsar. A branch Singh Sabha was also established at Amritsar to serve as a local centre. The objects of these associations were: To inculcate love for Sikhism among all those who call themselves Sikhs or Khalsa; to preach the principles of this great religion; to publish literature in aid of this religion; to publish the authentic texts of the Guru's Word and other books such as Janamsakhis and the Gurpanalis, after correcting and amending them; to promote the study of modern knowledge through the medium of Punjabi, and for this purpose to issue papers and magazines. Special care was taken to keep out apostates, the opponents of Sikhism, and those who had proved obnoxious to the Government. Even Europeans could become members in the educational branch. It was provided in the fundamental rules that nothing against the Government could be discussed in the Singh Sabha meetings.

These rules became the model for all the Sabhas founded in connection with this movement, Prof. Gurmukh Singh went about preaching the mission of the new order, and was able to create and get affiliated scores of Singh Sabhas in the Country. This made the Amritsar Diwan very prominent and all the influential people, even those who were conservative in their outlook, were attracted towards the centre of this movement. Baba Kham Singh Bedi, a descendant of Guru Nanak, became the president of Khalsa Diwan, Amritsar, and Prof. Gurmukh Singh its chief secretary, with several secretaries in charge of Sub-committees for religious, literary, educational and press matters. As the Akal Takht and the Golden Temple authorities were cooperating with this Diwan, the Hukumnamas from the Takht were often issued in favour of the reformers. This welcome phase, however, lasted only for a short time, because the Diwan contained many leading members whose zeal for reform was only skin deep. They were not ready to shed off the old tradition in its entirety. They still clung to untouchability, idol worship, man-worship, etc. There began to appear a cleavage between the whole huggers, most of whom belonged to the Lahore centre, and the slow-paced reformers who belonged to the Amritsar centre. Prof. Gurmukh Singh found his position more and more difficult. He was for the removal of the disabilities of the untouchables, who had been presenting their difficulties before the Diwan, but had always been put off with one excuse or another. Things came to head on the question of providing cushions for the seating of Baba Kham Singh, when he came to pay a visit to the Golden Temple. He claimed this a special privilege as a descendant of the founder of Sikhism. Prof. Gurmukh Singh and others of his way of thinking were against this practice. They wanted equal treatment for all, and did not want to allow any invidious distinction to be made in the presence of the Holy Guru Granth Sahib. Prof. Gurmukh Singh was forced to sever his connection with the Amritsar Diwan, and found a new Khalsa Diwan at Lahore, to which he affiliated almost all the Singh Sabhas. The Amritsar Diwan was left only with the Three Sabhas of Amritsar, Faridkot and Rawalpindi. Its president was Baba Khem Singh and secretary his staunch disciple, Bhai Avtar Singh Vahiria. This Diwan, though truncated, still enjoyed some prestige on account of its association with the Central temples and the great authority of Baba Khem Singh and certain ruling princes. It held its annual meeting as usual on the Diwali and Vaisakhi occasions. Maharaja Bikram Singh of Faridkot gave Rs. 75000 for erecting the building of the free kitchen attached to the Golden Temple. He also spent Rs. 25000 on the electrification of the sacred premises. To counteract the so-called innovation introduced by the extreme reformers like Bhai Gurmukh Singh a Hinduised commentary of the Holy Guru Granth Sahib was prepared by Gyani Badan Singh and published at the expense of the Faridkot Durbar. A stream of Books and pamphlets issued from the prolific pen of Bhai Avtar Singh Vahiria and others to meet the ever-advancing tide of reform-literature as produced by Bhai Dit Singh and Bhai Gurmukh Singh. Bhai Avtar Singh, in his book *Khalsa Sudhar Taru*, and later on in his bigger Books Called *Khalsa Dharam Shastar Gur Darshan Shastar*, tried to prove that the Sikhs were Hindus, that the Gurus worshipped gods and goddesses, and that it was wrong to convert Mohammedans to Sikhism, or to abolish caste-system and untouchability. After firing a few more shots in the air this fighter of a losing cause retired to his native city, Rawalpindi, along with his master, Baba Khem Singh, and gave no further trouble to the staunch reformers. Baba Kham Singh, however, did much for the spread of female education in the western Punjab, and brought thousands of Hindus into the fold of Sikhism.

Khalsa Diwan Of Lahore

All the real supporters of reform gathered round Bhai Gurmukh Singh who had founded the Khalsa Diwan of Lahore in 1886. Maharaja Hira Singh of Nabha was its patron, Sir Attar Singh, C.I.E., Shamsul Ulama and Mahamahopadhyaya, Chief of Bhodaur, its president, and Bhai Gurmukh Singh its secretary. It also enjoyed the

patronage of the Lieut. Governor of the Punjab and the Commander-in-Chief of India. In a short time all the best elements of Sikhism were attracted towards new Diwan. In the early days of reform, there was not much difference between Singh Sabha and Arya Samaj. Guru Granth Sahib used to be opened in the Samaj meeting, and many prominent Sikhs were found working shoulder to shoulder with the promoters of the Samaj. Bhai Jawahir Singh of Gujranwala, was one of them. He was a vice-president of the Samaj. Bhai Dit Singh and Bhai Mayya Singh, two speakers and writers were also working with him. They were, however, greatly annoyed by the attacks of their Samajist associates on the Sikhs Gurus, and they came away in disgust. They were welcomed with open arms by Bhai Gurmukh Singh, who saw in them great dynamic personalities, destined to work wonders in the cause of Sikhism. A press was already owned by the Khalsa Diwan. Now a newspaper, called *Khalsa Akhbar*, was started, with Bhai Dit Singh as its editor. Through his paper and scores of books,² written evidently with a gusto and force never known before, he was able to demolish the old theories of his opponents and to create a strong opinion in favour of the new movement. Incidentally modern poetry especially prose received a great impetus from his advocacy. His allegorical burlesque, called *Swapan Natak*, which was a disguised attack on Baba Khem Singh, involved him in some trouble through litigation but having influential personalities like Sir Attar Singh at his back he came out unharmed.

Two other personalities attracted by Bhai Gurmukh Singh were Bhai Kahan Singh of Nabha and Mr. M.A. Macauliffe. Bhai Kahan Singh was a great scholar of Sikh literature, Besides being trained in the old school of scholarship wherein depth of knowledge and mastery of detail was emphasised, he also cultivated a variety and vastness of view which is the characteristics of western learning. He did not possess the force and verve of Bhai Dit Singh, but he had more depth and comprehensiveness which made his work more permanent and less polemical. His book, *Ham Hindu Nahin*, did more to dehinduise the Sikhs than anything else. His other books *Gurmat Prabhakar* and *Gurmat Sudhakar* articulated Sikh doctrines most clearly. They were standard guide-books and sometimes the only stock-in-trade of the Sikh preachers. His later book, the *Encyclopedia of Sikh Literature*, was his *magnum opus*, and did much to elucidate the Sikh creed. Indirectly he was also responsible for much of the work done by Mr. Macauliffe, who studied the Sikhism under his care and was persuaded through him to give up a very lucrative Government post and join the Lahore Diwan for the purpose of translating the Sikh Scriptures. From 1893 to 1909 Mr. Macauliffe worked at this tremendous task, and completed it to the satisfaction of learned Sikhs. But by that time the Lahore Diwan had become defunct; and the new leaders, led by the inherent superstition or jealousy, did not approve of his publishing the Guru Granth Sahib in English. They said that it would mean desecration of the Holy Book, which would be carried about like any other volume without proper respect. Mr. Macauliffe was therefore obliged to give up the idea of publishing the translation of the whole Book, and had to content himself with giving only a few portions of it along with the lives of the Gurus.

Even this did not satisfy the factious party. The Government too, which had promised to help the author with a grant of Rs. 15,000, was now averse to paying anything more than Rs. 5,000, which the author declined to accept. He came to Rawalpindi in 1910, when the annual session of the Sikh Educational conference was being held. Nobody went to receive him at the railway station. Broken in health, and more broken on spirit, in account of the debt incurred in connection with the publication of *The Sikh Religion*, he appealed to the promoters of the Conference to include a resolution about his book, recommending that it was a work worthy of Sikh consideration. The permission asked for was refused and the old tottering benefactor of the Sikh had to return disappointed. He went back to England, and died soon after, in 1913. Then a resolution of appreciation was passed at the Educational Conference.

Another luminary who did yeoman's service to the cause of reform was Bhagat Lakshman Singh of Rawalpindi. He joined Sikhism in 1895, when he was thirty-three, and had already made a name as a writer and journalist. Reinforced by the enthusiasm of a new convert he threw himself heart and soul into the reform movement. He was serving as a Professor in the Gordon College, and was at the same time secretary of the local Singh Sabha. His bold advocacy of the Sikh cause, especially in the matter of spreading education among the masses, brought him up against Christian interests in villages, and he was obliged to sever his connection with the Mission College. He came to Lahore, and started a weekly journal, called the *Khalsa*, in English. The paper ran its course only for about two years, from 1899 to 1901, but it did much to counteract the nefarious propaganda of certain renegades from Sikhism (Baba Chhajju Singh and Baba Arjun Singh) who were spreading misrepresentations about the missions of the Sikh Gurus. Bhagat Lakshman Singh returned to Rawalpindi in 1901, and carried on an unceasing campaign of reform, which resulted in the formation of a network of Singh

Sabhas and Khalsa Schools in the Rawalpindi district. His Life of Guru Gobind Singh and scores of booklets, written off and on, laid the foundation of Sikh literature in English, which gives due prominence to the mission of the last Guru, which is often forgotten even by Sikhs.

There were many other leaders who touched the reform movement on its different sides. One such was Dr. Jai Singh of Rawalpindi, the founder of the famous firm of chemists on the Mall, Lahore. He carried on the work of shuddhi, reconverting those who had gone away to Islam or Christianity.

The main work of Khalsa Diwan was the foundation of the Khalsa College, Amritsar, in 1892, and laying those broad lines of reform which made the Sikh community self-conscious and self-contained. The dynamic force generated by Bhai Gurmukh Singh and his great associates was still working in full vigour, when God summoned him away from his field of action, and he died of heart failure in 1898. Sir Attar Singh³ had already died in 1896. Bhai Dit Singh died in 1901. The Lahore Diwan could not survive these incessant shocks, and its place was taken by the Chief Khalsa Diwan, Amritsar.

Chief Khalsa Diwan

The first meeting of the Chief Khalsa Diwan was held in the Malvai Bunga attached to the Golden Temple on the 30th October, 1902. The inaugural prayer was offered by Babu Teja Singh,⁴ of Bhasaur. Bhai Sahib Bhai Arjun Singh, chief of Bagarian, was elected president, and Sardar Sunder Singh Majithia, secretary of the Singh Sabha of Amritsar, was appointed secretary of the new Diwan. Out of about 150 Singh Sabhas, scattered all over the country, only 29 agreed to join. Their representatives, along with 47 others, formed the general body. With the exception of the few leading members who still stuck to the Lahore Diwan for the old sake's sake, most of the local workers, like Sodhi Sujan Singh, BA., Bhai Takht Singh of Ferozpur, Bhai Mohan Singh Vaid of Taran Taran, S. Sadhu Singh of Forest Department, S. Dharam Singh of Gharjakh, transferred their allegiance to the new dispensation, and began to give their best to it. Sodhi Sujan Singh became assistant secretary to the Chief Khalsa Diwan. Bhai Takht Singh, a staunch follower of Bhai Dit Singh, opened a research library of Sikh literature and history in connection with the Sikh Kanya Mehavidya, Ferozpur, and called it Bhai Dit Singh Library. He became an enthusiastic supporter of the new order in the spread of education and religious reform. Bhai Mohan Singh Vaid, who had done much to counteract the anti-sikh propaganda of the Arya Samaj, established a Punjabi Magazine, called Dukh Nivaran in 1906, and through its monthly issues as well as through pamphlets spread useful information about health and hygiene, home and its problems, and many other themes, bearing on modern life. Like Bhai Takht Singh he was a great antiquarian, sweet and humble, firm and persuasive—a type that is becoming rare nowadays.

It was such people who fixed the new type of man associated with the Chief Khalsa Diwan. The older type, associated with the Lahore Diwan, was distinguished for his bold, clear-cut views, and intellectual and controversial outlook, making use more often of historical and logical methods than of any spiritual or mystical means. The Chief Khalsa Diwan, on the other hand, represented a new ideology, which did not work so much for discovering any defects in the old system, developing new schools of criticism, or making a bold headway towards neglected reforms, as for supplying the great deficiency of depth and spiritual fervour. So far, according to the need of the time, all the work done had been destructive. The belief of Sikhs in the Hindu books and institutions had been demolished to a great extent, and they had been made to stand on their own ground. But they had not yet had time to look at their own ground, much less to think of building their own institutions on it. The only thing constructive done so far had been the spread of education, and the inculcation of the belief that the Sikhs were a separate community, which should have separate rights, separate institutions, and separate provisions in the law to protect them. Even the Anand Marriage Act, legislating the Sikh form of marriage, came in 1909. For all other purposes, we were, and are, governed by the Hindu Law. The greatest defect, however, was that our religious practice was not spiritual enough. It consisted mainly of attending weekly meeting of the Singh Sabha, in which lectures were delivered against Hindus and their institutions, or debates were held to controvert the attacks of the Arya Samajists. It was reserved for the Chief Khalsa Diwan to usher a new era of spiritual uplift. This was the work of certain holy men and gifted musicians. Sant Attar Singh of Mastuana was instrumental in inaugurating the practice of early rising and attending holy meetings where the sacred word was given out in entrancing music. Never since the days of the Holy Guru, had the Sikhs such spiritual experience. Never had they gathered in such large numbers to listen, in their hearts, to the deeply moving voice of the Guru, and there from to imbibe the mystery that is called Religion. Bhai Hira Singh Ragi's music, inter-spiced with his sacred lore, swayed the hearts of thousands, including even Hindus, and all forgot

the days when the Sikhs and Hindus used to fight over their doctrines. Sant Sangat Singh of Kamalia is another luminary of the same order who has come to reconcile intellect with spirit, and whose spiritual talk subdues all controversies and hushes all bickerings. Bhai Vir Singh of Amritsar, who fights shy of speaking in big meetings, has nevertheless had a strong influence in moulding the new type of man, especially among those who lead the movement. His influence on Sikh literature too has been most creative. He may be called almost the originator of modern Punjabi poetry, and his religio-historical romances in prose have done more than any thing else to advance the mission of reformed Sikhism. Besides these S.B.Jodh Singh, M.A., and Sardar Trilochan Singh, M.A., L.L.B., have had a great deal to do with the formation of Sikh opinion. The latter with his business acumen, as manager of the Punjab & Sind Bank, has linked up the different Sikh institutions and business magnates with Bank, and through it with the leaders of the Chief Khalsa Diwan.

The Diwan enjoyed the greatest prestige among Sikhs from 1902 upto 1914. Its secretary Sardar Sunder Singh Majithia, was also the secretary of the Khalsa College, the premier institution of the Sikhs with which were associated the most influential officials of the Government. The members of The Diwan were mostly drawn from the elite of the community. When the Khalsa College went into the hands of the Government in 1908, most of the leaders of the Diwan withdrew from the management of the College and came to found a new institution, the Sikh Educational Conference, which was as important as the college, Educational Conference, which was as important as the college, if not more. It was controlled by the educational committee of the Diwan, and held its sitting annually in different centers. Whenever it met, it left a school behind it, until in a few years it came to support a host⁵ of Primary Middle and High Schools. It heroically fought for the cause of the Punjabi language, and its influence was felt by the educational, postal and railway authorities. The Sikh Schools were not only dispensers of education, but they also served as strongholds of Sikhism wherever they were established. Even the Singh Sabhas, which were organized for propagating reform, could not compete in popularity with the schools.

This spread of education created among the Sikhs a public spirit with which they came to feel their religious and political disabilities. By 1914 this feeling of discontent was aggravated by the *Komagata Maru* and the *Rikab Ganj* affairs, and at the same time the minds of Sikhs were being stirred by the events of the Great War, which was creating a passion for democracy everywhere. The Sikhs were no longer content with the leadership of the Chief Khalsa Diwan. Led by such bold papers as the *Panth Sewak* of Lahore, they wanted the Diwan to quicken its pace, or to get out of the way and give its place to some other body. But there was no other body yet born, and the Diwan had to carry on as well as it could. In spite of its representations the Sikh claims had been ignored in the Minto-Morley scheme and even in the Montford scheme, which recognized the Sikh's claim to separate representation, only 8 seats out of 54 were recommended for them. In the autumn session of the Punjab Council in 1918, while refusing to accept the amendment of S. Gajjan Singh to his resolution recommending the distribution of seats between Hindus and Mohammedans according to the Congress plan, Mian Fazl-i-Hussain told the Sardar that as his community had kept aloof from the Congress it had no ground to complain. This was a clear indication to Sikhs that they could no longer rely for the protection of their rights on the support of the Government or of those bodies which could not afford to break away from it. The Sikhs, therefore, organized a political body of their own, called the *Sikh League*, and held its first session at Amritsar, along with the Congress, in 1919. They also started a paper, called the *Akali*, at Lahore. It had great influence with the common people in villages. A new phase of reform began among the Sikhs. It was called the Akali Movement.

Akali Movement

The previous movements of reform had touched only the white-collar people of cities. The new movement was truly democratic. It came from villages, and upto this time has been controlled mainly by the rural element, which does not make any nice distinction between religious and political matters. It does not see much use for the educated element, which is supposed-perhaps truly-to be supine and nerveless, and therefore unfit to be trusted for showing vigour or sacrifice in times of emergency.

It is not the purpose of this chapter to describe the great movement of Gurdwara reform, which entailed so much suffering and sacrifice. It was indeed a task quite beyond the capacity of the Chief Khalsa Diwan, and it was well that the Guru chose a new set of people who alone could have dash and determination required for the purpose. It opened the way for real reform of religion, which had been obstructed by the fact that the Sikh temples were in the hands of unreformed priests. No amount of preaching or education, which the Singh Sabha movement had so far achieved, could actually effect any improvement in the rites and ceremonies observed by

Sikhs as long as the performers of these rites and ceremonies-the priests-were strongly entrenched behind the law of the land against all reforms. It was necessary, therefore, that the management of the temples should be in the hands of those who wanted reform. By going through untold sufferings the Sikhs, called the Akalis, have secured a law, which gives them control over all the historical Gurdwaras.

All this change, however, means a change on the management side only, and does not necessarily mean any reform in the service or ritual observed in the temples. In effect, the talk of reform is a luxury indulged in by those who are outside the pale of management. Those who are actually running the show have to look to the taste of the audiences. They cannot afford to make any sudden changes in the daily routine of worship observed in the temples. The Akalis, as priests, do not find themselves as helpless as their predecessors, because the audiences are not the same as before. They made some improvements. As for example, women are allowed to go up to the holy of holies in the Akal Takht, which they could not do before ; but it will take some time before they are allowed to take part in the actual services, such as singing hymns in the Golden temple or taking part in the administering baptism. They have abolished certain obnoxious customs, such as the annual killing of a goat before the Akal Takht, and the worship of idols in the precincts. But, other customs for which there is no authority in Sikhism, still continue to hold the ground.

There is a sacred lamp called jot, still burning in the Golden Temple. The people are still seen pressing the marble walls of the Baba Atal, or touching worshipfully the lock of the treasure-room. The anniversaries of the Gurus have begun to be celebrated with great éclat, but the Hindu days of *Amavas* and *Puranmasi* are still attracting greater crowds to the Sikh temples. The strange kinds of recitation, such as the sampath path, are not encouraged, but who can say that recitations still allowed are quite free from superstitions?

The reason is obvious. No party that has to run institutions can help being conservative. It has to satisfy many helpful interests. It cannot afford to antagonise its audience. And the Akalis are no exception to this rule. There are other reasons besides this. The authority of the Shromani Gurdwara Prbandhak Committee, which controls the management of the Sikh temples, is free from outside control, but it is not yet acknowledged by all the Sikh elements are supreme in religious matters. Certain Sikhs, among the Udasis and Nirmalas, whose temples come into the ambit of the Gurdwara Act, also refuse to admit its authority, and are ready, when challenged in the court of law, to declare that they are not Sikhs. (And yet, strange to say, when they succeed in their attempt to save a temple in this way by apostatizing themselves, the first thing they do is to offer thanks before the Holy Granth!). The Chief Khalsa Diwan has always stood apart, considering itself as competent to decide the Panthic affairs as the S.G.P.C. Under these circumstances the S.G.P.C. cannot feel strong enough to enforce unity of belief or worship, or to apply sanctions when anybody proves refractory.

At present there are mainly two schools of thought: one dominated by the Chief Khalsa Diwan, which, continuing the old tradition of the Amritsar Diwan, is more conservative; and the other by the S.G.P.C. which, inheriting the extreme tendencies of the Lahore diwan, is more critical. The former, inspired by Bhai Vir Singh and his paper, the *Khalsa Samachar*, emphasis the divinity of the gurus who are identified with God, while the latter believes in the humanity of the Gurus and is less mystical. The one stresses the worship of the saints, and comes out now and then with biographies of holy men, who preached asceticism and self-renunciation; while the other party holds this kind of things as mere man-worship and does not encourage too much kowtowing before human beings. They also do not favour the use of a rosary in worship, the whispering of Mantras in private into the ears of disciples, the letting or sub-letting of recitations and other mysteries which are indulged in by the saints of these latter days.

In my view, there are two great elements of Sikhism: One is Nam (or the Name) and other is sewa (or Service). The Chief Khalsa Diwan has come to emphasis the practice of Nam, and does not see much opportunity for sewa, while the other party has come to monopolise Sewa, without seeing much use in practicing Nam. The desirable thing would be to combine the two. When that is done, the Khalsa will be one and supreme.

Footnotes:

1. This was a sop throw to the Sikh notables who had liberally contributed towards the fund of the University. Instead of giving the Sikhs any special privileges in the University, the promoters of the University scheme made a special provision for the teaching of Punjabi in the Oriental College. This privilege was not given to Urdu or Hindi, See the rules of the College as framed originally in 1888. But now those rules have been

modified to include Urdu and Hindi as well. They run: They university shall maintain an Oriental College with the main object of promoting the advanced and enlightened study of Sanskrit, Arabic, Persian and such other modern Indian Languages as the Syndicate may appoint.

2. Some of them were: *Life of Guru Nanak, Durga Parbodh, My Discussions with Swami Dayanand, Biographies of Sikh Heroes.*
3. He was one of the most learned men of his time. Some well known books by him were: *The Sakhi Book, Travels of Guru Teg Bahadur, Rahitnama of Prahlad Singh and Nand Lal.*
4. He became a great dissenter later on, and founded a new association, called the *Panch Khalsa Diwan*, which did useful work in propagating the mission of Guru Gobind Singh, but in the end floundered pitifully in trying to rearrange the text of the Holy Granth by excluding the compositions of the Bards and including those of the Tenth Guru.
5. So far it has held 30 sitting, and has dispensed Rs. 499548 to different schools in the form of aid and Rs. 69200 as stipends to many students. Before the opening of this conference there were not more than score of Sikh schools, in the whole province, but now the number is:
For boys: 5 colleges, 61 high schools, 35 middle schools, 2 lower middle schools, 45 primary schools, 7 hostels, 6 miscellaneous.
For girls: 1 college, 4 high schools, 25 middle schools, 150 primary, and 11 mixed schools.